

1 Welcome Letter

Dear Math Team Sponsors, Coaches, and Students,

You are cordially invited to attend the 21st annual James S. Rickards Fall Invitational, a mathematics competition to be held on **Saturday, November 14, 2026**. The Rickards Invitational is one of the largest competitions in the Southeast with nearly 900 competitors from 42 elementary, middle, and high schools last year.

We encourage all elementary schools to participate, regardless of currently having math teams or not. We hope that this competition will inspire students to pursue the study of mathematics and will be an enjoyable experience for all who attend. It is our standard to write and administer error-free and high-quality tests and our aim to host this competition as effectively and appropriately as possible.

Registration may be completed online at <https://rickardsinvitational.github.io/>. The fee is \$10 per student until Thursday, October 30th. Late registration will be available until Wednesday, November 4th and will be \$15 per student. We strongly urge you to register by the regular deadline to guarantee that there is enough time for hosts to update their records, take inventory, and accommodate participants. On the day of the competition, sponsors will sign-in their teams at Rickards Auditorium and the first testing session will begin at 9:30 AM. A complete schedule of events is attached.

To prepare you for competition events, the rules guiding our Invitational are detailed in this Competition Handbook. Calculators will not be permitted on any test. We will have an Elementary Individual tests for all elementary students which will be divided into separate awards for the different grades. Please see Section 2 for more details.

If you have any questions, please contact us at **rickardsinvitational@gmail.com**. We look forward to your participation at our Invitational.

Sincerely,

Hugo Mayorga
Math Team Sponsor

Rakesh Raj
Director

2 Competition Format/Events

Eligibility

All students must compete in the division for their specific grade. Ambitious third graders are welcome to participate in the Fourth Grade division.

Individual Test

The competition will consist of an Individual test which both divisions (Fourth Grade and Fifth Grade) will take. There will be 30 multiple choice questions on this test, and students will have 1 hour to complete the problems. Scoring is 5 points for each correct answer, 0 points for each incorrect answer, and 1 point for a question left blank. Any ties will be broken using a sudden death method (beginning at Question 1) where correct answers trump blank answers which then trump incorrect answers. For past tests, please visit the Rickards Invitational website:

<https://rickardsinvitational.github.io/>.

3 Awards

A breakdown of the awards given is presented below:

Individual Tests

Awards will be given to the top 15 competitors in the Individual Exam.

4 Preliminary Schedule

Please note that this is a preliminary schedule of events and is subject to small changes prior to Saturday, November 14th. An official schedule of events, complete with room numbers/event locations, will be distributed in the competition program on the morning of the competition. Any updates prior to November 14th will be posted on the Invitational website.

8:00 – 8:45 AM	Registration (Auditorium)
8:45 – 9:15 AM	Scantron Preparation (Auditorium)
9:30 – 11:00 AM	Round 1 Testing
	Individual Tests: Elementary
11:00 – 11:20 AM	Disputes
11:30 PM– 1:45 PM	Lunch
2:15 – 2:45 PM	Award Ceremony (Auditorium)

5 Registration

Registration may be completed online at <https://rickardsinvitational.github.io/>. The fee is \$10 per student until the October 30th deadline. Schools that pay after the deadline but by November 4th will be charged \$15 per student. Once again, we strongly urge you to register by the regular deadline to guarantee that there is enough time for hosts to update their records, take inventory, and accommodate the participants. Once you complete registration, you will receive a confirmation email within 48 hours that holds an invoice, details on how to pay your registration fees, and any other details that need to be addressed.

We will be assigning ID numbers for each of your students after you register online with a list of students competing. We will also be creating and printing the bubble sheets for the test. All the students need to bring is their pencils!

<https://anirudhrahul.github.io/FAMATBubbler/>

We will also have additional, empty scantrons. Each of your students will be assigned to a classroom to take the Individual test. When you arrive on the morning of November 14th, you can sign-in your school in the Rickards Auditorium, where you will be given a packet with scantrons that are already filled and room assignments.

We hope to see you on November 14th! Thank you.